



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Writing Spot: Write a letter of reference!



Learning Outcome

Describe hypothetical situations in written and spoken interactions according to work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- What do you admire about your best friend?
- What skills do you feel your friend has that would transfer into the workplace?

Can Do Statements

- I can write about events and experiences related to jobs.
- I can write about future plans.
- I can write a recommendation letter.





Let's Explore!

Kristi asks her old boss for a letter of recommendation.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Dear Janet,

I am applying for work at BFP as an editorial assistant and I was wondering if I could ask for a letter of reference. I would have written to you earlier, but I have been quite busy. They are going to need a little information about what I did for you as an intern at Polygon. They are also going to want some specific details and perhaps a brief description of some of the skills I developed while working there. They need it by the end of the week if that's alright. I'm volunteering in your area on Thursday, could I swing by your office and pick the letter up in the afternoon? Would that be ok?

Thanks again,
Kristi

Dear Kristi,

I would be happy to write you a letter of recommendation, just send me the information about the company and I will write it up today. No need to come in to get it. I'll e-mail it to you.

Regards,
Janet

It is with great pleasure and confidence that I offer this recommendation on behalf of Ms. Kristi Lenard as I know her to be an enthusiastic and diligent employee. As her direct supervisor at Polygon in Boston, I found Kristi to be a great asset to the organization. Albeit a newer addition to the staff, she always handled herself with poise and confidence. Her great flexibility enabled her to successfully learn and become very capable with several of our software packages. As a copy editor, I found Kristi's writing skills to be impeccable and Kristi always fulfilled her administrative obligations in a timely and professional manner. Furthermore, her pleasant demeanor and sociable nature made her a definite asset in the staff room. I unhesitatingly offer my highest recommendation for Kristi as an excellent copywriter, a dedicated professional, a receptive and diligent employee and an affable and highly collaborative colleague. In my opinion, hiring Kristi would be a no-brainer.





Let's Practice!

Kristi is a great employee!

Instructions: Choose the words from the Word Bank to correctly complete the sentences.

1. I found Kristi to be a great asset to the organization, _____ a newer addition to the staff.
2. She's an _____ and highly _____ colleague.
3. I found Kristi's writing skills to be _____.
4. I offer my highest recommendation for Kristi as an excellent copywriter, a dedicated professional, and _____ employee.
5. In my opinion, hiring Kristi would be a _____.

Word Bank

- brains
- collaborate
- a diligent
- collaborative
- albeit
- affable
- no-brainer
- impeccable



Let's Practice!

Asking for a recommendation letter.

Instructions: Proofread the sentences below and circle the mistakes you find. Correct the sentences.

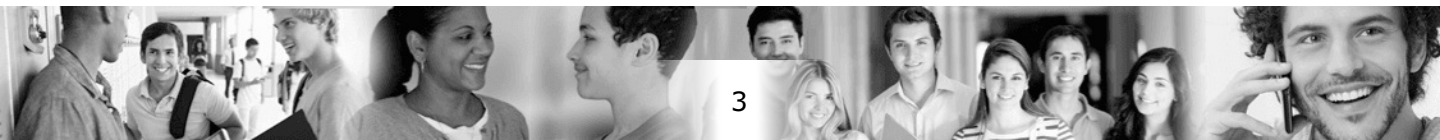
1. They are going to needing just a little information.

2. They are also going to want to knowing some specific details.

3. I'm volunteer in your area on Thursday.

4. I will writed it up today.

5. I'll e-mailed the reference letter to you.





Extension Activity

Writing a letter of reference for a friend.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Go online and find a job listing you think would be suitable for a friend.
- If you cannot find one then create one.
- Make a list of reasons why your friend would be suitable for that job.
- Write a reference letter including how you know your friend, and specific details about their character, skills and experiences necessary to do the job.
- Read your reference aloud to a partner and ask for feedback.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I identify a potential job opportunity online for a friend.

☐ ☐

I write a letter of reference that includes how I know my friend.

☐ ☐

I give reasons why s/he is suitable for the job and specific examples of skills s/he has.

☐ ☐

I give feedback to my partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- albeit** (conjunction): although
e.g. I found Kristi to be a great asset to the organization, albeit a newer addition to the staff.
- collaborative** (adjective): willing to work with others
e.g. She's an affable and highly collaborative employee.
- diligent** (adjective): hard-working
e.g. I offer my highest recommendation for Kristi as an excellent copywriter, a dedicated professional, and a diligent employee.
- impeccable** (adjective): faultless
e.g. I found Kristi's writing skills to be impeccable.
- no-brainer** (expression): requiring no debate
e.g. In my opinion, hiring Kristi would be a no-brainer.





Learning Points

The Future

You can use four different tenses to talk about the future.

When you talk about things that are not decided or when you make a decision at the moment of speaking for the future, you use the modal *will*.

When you ask about intentions, you use *be going to*.

When you talk about things that are arranged, on the agenda or booked for the future, you use the Present Continuous tense.

When you talk about schedules, you use the Simple Present.

Will	<i>Did you apply there? Oh, then I'll apply there too.</i>
Be going to	<i>I'm going to write a reference letter for my cousin. My former boss isn't going to write me a reference letter.</i>
Present Continuous	<i>I'm leaving my interview now. I'm interviewing for a job at 2 p.m. tomorrow.</i>
Simple Present	<i>It starts at 11:00 a.m.</i>

Examples:

- *They are going to need just a little information about what I did for you as an intern at Polygon.*
- *They are also going to want to know some specific details and perhaps a brief description of some of the skills I developed while working there.*
- *They need it by the end of the week if that's alright.*
- *I'm volunteering in your area.*
- *I will write it up today.*
- *I'll e-mail it to you.*





Learning Points

Writing a Reference Letter

You write a **reference letter** (or **recommendation letter**) for someone applying for a job. Primarily, a reference letter is used to introduce a person and vouch for their integrity, character, and abilities.

Your reference letter should look professional. Don't make it too long. Employers generally prefer that a reference letter fits on one page.

A reference letter should ...

- be professional looking and sounding both in style and in format.
- not be too long or too brief as to not include enough valuable information.
- explain how you know the subject and how long you have known each other.
- be full of specific examples of the subject's work history and use of skills.
- list your own contact information if you are willing to receive follow-up correspondence or answer questions.
- have a strong ending usually recommending the subject for the new position.

When you write a reference letter, try and emphasize the positive and omit the negative.

